GOOD 2026 Speaker Recommendations

Thank you for being part of the 2026 Global Open OnDemand (GOOD) Conference! We are committed to making this event inclusive and accessible for all attendees. To support you, we've put together some helpful tips as a guide to ensure your presentation is welcoming and accessible to everyone. These tips are not only for the benefit of our in-person audience but also for the broader online audience who will view recorded sessions..

Preparing for your presentation:

- Check out these guides for making your slides more accessible (PowerPoint | Google). In particular:
    - Use high contrast between text and backgrounds
    - Use color combinations that are accessible for people who are colorblind.
    - Use alt text for images and graphics.
- If possible, use closed captioning or sign language overlays.
    - Instructions for live captioning (Google Slides | Microsoft PowerPoint)
- If you use videos in your presentation, consider including audio descriptions in them
- Make any printed material also available in large print format.
- Review your presentation to ensure that the content is respectful, inclusive, and empowering for all.

Delivering your presentation:

- You will be required to use a microphone
- Ask audience members to use microphones when asking questions. If the member doesn't, please repeat the question into the microphone. It will ensure that everyone in the room can hear the question as well as help us include it via closed captions.
- Maintain a non-judgmental attitude by welcoming all questions, regardless of their complexity.
- Consider incorporating an anonymous question submission method, such as using tools like Mentimeter during your presentation.
- Avoid prioritizing the loudest, most experienced, or quickest learners. Create opportunities for quieter and less experienced participants to engage and contribute.
- Use gender-neutral language (such as "colleagues"). More info below.
- We encourage you to include your pronouns when you introduce yourself
- Do not use quick-flashing/strobing lights and/or video elements.
- If your presentation involves dividing the audience into groups, use categories such as birth months or ice cream flavor preferences, or just split the room in segments

Preparing and Presenting: Language Choices

Some commonly used words and phrases can be offensive to others. This guide offers valuable insights and suggestions for inclusive language—start incorporating these alternatives into your practice. We have included an edited version of this guide on the following page. Please consider the following when preparing and presenting at the GOOD26 conference:

- Use gender-neutral language:
  - Suggestions include: colleagues, peers, one and all
  - Use the term "they" instead of he or she, unless you happen to know the person's preferred pronoun
- Avoid ableist language:
  - Rather than Handicap(ped) use: Disabled person, physically disabled person, wheelchair-user, person with a disability
- Avoid co-opting the language surrounding established cultures
  - All individuals can be a part of a community, but not all communities are "tribes."
- Be deliberate with contextualized language
  - Consider your audience and how idioms and phrases may have different meanings to different individuals.

Aspect of inclusive language	**Unpreferred word/phrase**	**It's better to say**	**Why?**
Gender-neutral language	Latino/Latina	Latine	This can reinforce binary gender stereotypes and exclude non-binary people.
Proper acknowledgment of people and cultures	indigenous peoples	Indigenous Peoples	You need to capitalize the names of cultures, nationalities, and religions.
	tribe	community	Don't appropriate words from cultures with established meanings.
Respectful language	Sexual preference	Sexual orientation	This term has a contested implication that someone's sexuality is their choice.
Intentional language	A female scientist, an asian scientist	A scientist	Think about what descriptions are necessary, and the relevance of mentioning someone's gender/race
Non-stereotypical language	Man up	Be brave	This term perpetuates stereotypes that men need to appear strong at all times and implies women can't be.
	IT guy	System Admin	Instead of an IT guy, use a person's specific title. The generalization should not be their gender.
Diverse and accurate representation	Manmade	Artificial, manufactured	This phrase ignores the role women and non-binary people play in shaping our history and our future.

References:

- NumFOCUS DISCOVER Cookbook (Diverse & Inclusive Spaces and Conferences: Overall Vision and Essential Resources) - https://discover-cookbook.numfocus.org/intro.html
- The Ultimate Writing Guide to Inclusive Language - https://www.acrolinx.com/blog/the-quick-guide-to-inclusive-language/
- The Carpentries Toolkit of IDEAS - https://zenodo.org/records/10391883
- Words Matter! Disability Language Etiquette - https://www.nea.org/words-matter-disability-language-etiquette
- Why we do not use the word “tribe” - https://november-project.com/why-we-do-not-use-the-word-tribe-ottawa/
- 10 Simple Rules to Make a Conference Inclusive - https://journals.plos.org/ploscompbiol/article?id=10.1371/journal.pcbi.1010164
- Section508.gov – Making presentations accessible - https://www.section508.gov/create/presentations/
- Microsoft PowerPoint Accessibility - https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/office/make-your-powerpoint-presentations-accessible-to-people-with-disabilities-6f7772b2-2f33-4bd2-8ca7-dae3b2b3ef25
- Google Slides Accessibility - https://support.google.com/docs/answer/6199477?hl=en